ROLL ON.

Market entry & sales for Taiwan and Asia

TAIWAN MARKET ENTRY REPORT • Q4 2026

Where Foreign Companies Can Win in Taiwan

The numbers, the industries and the buyer insights you need before you enter Asia's fastest-growing economy.

FROM VISIONS TO BIG IMPACTS

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AT A GLANCE

Taiwan is growing faster than at any time since 1988

Foreign money and talent are following the growth. The window is open for companies that learn to **sell the way Taiwanese buyers buy**.

11.05%
GDP growth forecast for 2026, a 39-year high

US$903.6B
Goods exports forecast for 2026, +41%

US$19.2B
Approved foreign investment, Jan–Sep 2026, +119%

1.03M+
Foreign residents in Taiwan, a record

NT$5.08T
Retail market forecast for 2026, first time above NT$5T

31.8%
Working-age people using generative AI, ahead of the US

Three opportunities

01
AI for SMEs

Only about 12% of Taiwan's SMEs use AI, and the government is funding them to adopt it.

02
Premium consumer brands

Retail is growing again, and online sales will pass NT$500B for the first time.

03
Build in Taiwan, sell to Asia

The supply chain, new talent rules and visas make Taiwan a practical regional base.

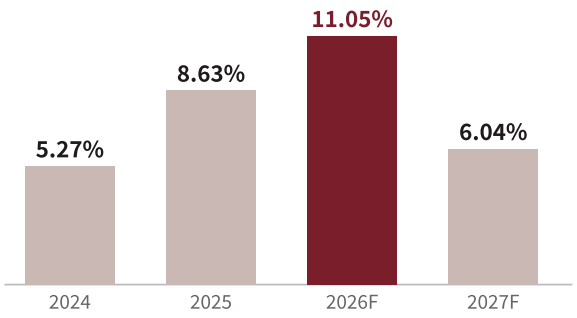
Why most foreign companies struggle: not because the product is weak, but because they sell the way they sell at home. This report shows you what Taiwanese buyers need to see.

01 • THE ECONOMY

The fastest growth in 39 years

Taiwan's statistics office (DGBAS) forecasts **11.05% GDP growth in 2026**. The engine is AI: servers, chips and cloud equipment shipped to the US and the world. The economy will be about **US$1.05 trillion**.

Real GDP growth, Taiwan



F = forecast • Source: DGBAS

Indicator	2026F	2027F
GDP per person	US$45,332	US$49,874
Goods exports	US$903.6B +41.2%	US$1,072.5B +18.7%
Inflation (CPI)	2.07%	1.90%
H1 2026 growth	14.15%	

2025 actual: GDP +8.63%, exports US$640.8B (+34.9%), CPI 1.66%.

What this means for a foreign company

- **Buyers have budget.** Private investment came in far above forecasts. Growing companies are buying software, services and talent.
- **Consumers are spending again.** Stock-market gains are spilling into consumption, a better window for consumer brands than 2025.
- **The growth is uneven.** Tech and AI supply chains are booming faster than the rest. Sell to the companies riding the AI wave, or to the people they employ.

Sources: DGBAS forecast of 14 Aug 2026 via TechNews and Want Rich; 2025 GDP via Commercial Times; 2025 exports via Trading Economics; 2025 CPI via Ministry of Economic Affairs year-end briefing.

02 • FOREIGN MONEY AND TALENT

Investment has doubled, and foreigners are arriving in record numbers

Approved foreign investment **more than doubled** in the first nine months of 2026, and more foreigners live and work in Taiwan than ever before.

Indicator	Latest figure	Period
Approved foreign direct investment	US$19.2B, +119%, 1,718 cases	Jan–Sep 2026
Foreign residents	1.03 million+ (record)	Jan 2026
Foreigners working in Taiwan	860,000+ (record)	Jan 2026
Foreign white-collar professionals	about 56,000	Apr 2026
Employment Gold Cards approved	17,365 total; 8,973 valid	Jun 2026
International visitors	8.67M in 2025; 4.29M in H1 2026 (+2.3%)	2025–26
Visitor spending (excl. air tickets)	US$11.03B, +10.0%	2025

> **Read the investment number with care.** About half of the 2026 total is one deal: Micron's roughly US$9.45B capital increase. Offshore wind adds about US$2.3B. But most of the **1,718 cases** are companies closer to your size.

Rules for foreign talent got easier on 1 January 2026

- Graduates of the world's top 1,500 universities skip the 2-year work-experience rule (was top 500).
- Graduates of the top 200 can get a 2-year work permit without an employer.
- The digital nomad visa now allows a total stay of up to 2 years.
- Foreign professionals join the new labour pension: employers pay 6% of salary.

Sources: Investment Commission data via UAnalyze (15 Oct 2026); residents and workers via NOWnews; professionals via PTS; Taiwan Gold Card Office; visitors via Want Rich and Storm Media; talent law via KPMG Taiwan.

03 • ASIA HUB

Why Taiwan is the right hub for Asia

Taiwan ranked the **4th most competitive economy in the world** in 2026, its best result ever, and 1st among economies of 20M+ people for six years.

- **Control your supply chain from one island.** High-speed rail links Taipei and Kaohsiung in as little as 1 hour 34 minutes: visit factories, suppliers and customers in a single day.
- **Ship by sea and air.** An island between Northeast and Southeast Asia, with ports in Kaohsiung, Taichung and Keelung. Kaohsiung handled 8.9M TEU in 2025 and is rated a top-10 container port by DNV.
- **Innovative, well-educated, responsible teams.** Local teams work daily with the world's leading tech companies. IMD ranks Taiwan 4th for business efficiency.
- **Rule of law and IP protection.** A lower-risk place to build and protect designs and IP for companies diversifying away from China.

Taiwan or Singapore?

Use Singapore as your regional headquarters, and Taiwan as the place where you build, test and sell. Singapore ranks 1st in IMD 2026 and is Asia's finance hub; Taiwan wins where growing companies spend their time and money.

	Taiwan	Singapore
Manufacturing & supply chain	Full chain, from chips and AI servers to small-batch prototyping	Limited by land; mainly a management and finance hub
Home market to test in	About 23 million people	About 6 million people
Grade A office rent	NT$3,118 / ping / month (Q2 2026), about one-third of Singapore	S$12.50 / sq ft / month (Core CBD, Q2 2026)
Office fit-out cost	US$1,593 / m^2	US$2,029 / m^2, highest in Asia-Pacific
IMD competitiveness 2026	4th; 1st among 20M+ economies for 6 years	1st

> **Many companies use both:** Singapore for finance and contracts, Taiwan to build, run the supply chain and win first customers.

Sources: IMD 2026 (Focus Taiwan, Liberty Times); UpToGo; Taipei Times; Taiwan News; CBRE Taipei & Singapore Q2 2026; Knight Frank (IREI). Rents compared at recent exchange rates.

04 • INDUSTRIES

Three industries where foreign companies can win

Roll On focuses on **AI and SaaS**, **consumer brands**, and **supply chain and hardware prototyping**. Demand is real in all three.

AI and SaaS: from building AI to using it

- **Market:** 31.8% of working-age people use generative AI (20th globally). IDC expects AI platform spending to grow from US$134M (2025) to US$608M (2029).
- **Gap:** Only 11.9% of SMEs use AI. The government's Ten AI Initiatives plan (Jan 2026) targets SMEs and traditional industries.
- **Who buys:** Mid-sized manufacturers and service firms, often led by a second- or third-generation owner.
- **Common mistake:** Pitching features in English to a buyer who wants a local case, Chinese materials and a pilot.
- **Opportunity:** AI tools for SMEs that fit subsidy programmes, sold through a local partner.

Consumer brands: a NT$5 trillion retail market

- **Market:** Retail is forecast at NT$5.08T in 2026 (+4.9%); online retail passes NT$500B for the first time.
- **Where growth is:** E-commerce, department stores and convenience stores (about NT$1.5T together).
- **Common mistake:** Competing on discounts from day one. Brands that start cheap struggle to raise prices.
- **Opportunity:** Premium and niche brands that sell on a clear advantage, through one strong channel first.

Supply chain and prototyping: build in Taiwan, sell to Asia

- **Market:** Taiwan makes the world's AI servers and advanced chips; the same ecosystem serves small hardware teams.
- **Common mistake:** Approaching big factories that only take large orders. Introductions and trust matter more than a price list.
- **Opportunity:** Roll On works with suppliers that accept small orders: prototype in Taiwan, then scale across Asia.

Sources: Focus Taiwan (May 2026); DIGITIMES (Jun 2026); Meta Intelligence (IDC forecast); Future Commerce Institute via 104 and FoodNext; CPA Australia. Buyer behaviour and mistakes are Roll On's field observations.

05 • GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

What you can use, and what needs a Taiwan company

Taiwan offers strong visa and talent programmes, but **most grants only go to companies registered in Taiwan**. Plan your entity before your subsidy.

Programme	What you get	Taiwan entity?
Employment Gold Card	Work permit, resident visa and re-entry permit in one card	No
Entrepreneur Visa	Residence to start and run a startup; via a recognised incubator, a patent or funding	To run the business
Digital nomad visa	Up to 2 years in total while working for a company abroad	No
Top-university work permits	Top 1,500: no experience rule; top 200: 2-year permit without employer	Depends
Taiwan Startup Stadium	Free membership: mentors, investor matching, workshops; 210+ members	No
SME Smart Business (AI)	Subsidy for SMEs adopting AI; NT$310M budget in 2026	Yes (the buyer)

Two ways to use this

1. **Selling AI or software to SMEs?** The subsidy goes to your customer. Make it easy for them to apply and you shorten the sales cycle.
2. **Moving to Taiwan as a founder?** Start with the Gold Card or Entrepreneur Visa and an incubator. The 2026 law changes widened who qualifies.

> **From Roll On's experience:** government buyers, many hospitals and large enterprises will not sign without a Taiwan entity. Test the market first, then set up a company when buyers are ready to sign.

Sources: Taiwan Gold Card Office; MOEA law database; Nanoglobals; KPMG Taiwan; Meta Intelligence. Programme rules change often: check the official page before you apply.

06 • BUYER INSIGHTS

How Taiwanese buyers really decide

Foreign companies rarely fail because the product is weak. They fail because they **don't speak the buyer's language**: not just Mandarin, but how trust is built and decisions are made.

- **Trust before contract.** Buyers want an introduction and a face-to-face meeting before price. Cold email alone rarely works.
- **Pilot first, then scale.** Most companies want a small trial first. Plan for it and price it.
- **Local proof beats global logos.** One Taiwanese customer case often outweighs a list of famous overseas clients.
- **Chinese materials and LINE.** A Traditional Chinese deck and a LINE contact show you are here to stay.
- **Decisions are layered.** The person you meet is rarely the one who signs. Map decision-makers early.
- **Discounts are a trap.** Sell on your clear advantage and protect your price from day one.

Case study • A US medical device company, from zero to channels in one year

The team arrived with no Taiwan entity and no local network. Roll On built its market, pricing and investment strategy and introduced it to investors.

1 year
to open government and medical distributor channels, plus early fundraising

160+
expo visitors completed its survey

50%
said they would buy after seeing the product; 40%+ asked for promotions

It is now expanding into the consumer and pet markets. Roll On has also helped a large Japanese company launch a range of products that sell in Taiwan.

07 • ROADMAP

A three-stage roadmap into Taiwan

Move to the next stage only when you pass its gate. This keeps your cost low until buyers prove they will pay.

STAGE 1
Test the market
Weeks 1–8

- Define your Taiwanese buyer and the 3 problems you solve
- Meet 10–20 potential buyers in person
- Pitch in Traditional Chinese; set a local price

Gate: 3+ buyers ready to pilot

STAGE 2
Close first deals
Months 3–6

- Run pilots with clear success criteria
- Sign first customers and channel partners
- Set up a Taiwan entity when contracts require it

Gate: paying customers + a local case

STAGE 3
Scale across Asia
Month 6+

- Hire locally with Gold Card and new talent rules
- Use Taiwan as your base for Japan, Korea and Southeast Asia
- Raise from investors who know the region

Goal: a regional business

Before-you-enter checklist

- ☐ We can name our Taiwanese buyer and why they pay
- ☐ We have spoken to 10+ potential buyers in Taiwan
- ☐ Our pitch is in Traditional Chinese
- ☐ We have a local price that doesn't rely on discounts
- ☐ We know which deals need a Taiwan entity
- ☐ We know which visa our team will use
- ☐ We have a local partner for introductions

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About Roll On

Roll On helps foreign companies sell in Taiwan and grow across Asia. We combine market-entry strategy with real sales execution, in Mandarin, English and Taiwanese, with both foreign and local business communities.

Phase 1 • Market Entry Plan
Your Taiwan buyers, competitors, price point and go-to-market plan, in about 7 days.

Phase 2 • Sales Strategy
Face-to-face buyer meetings, a target-company list, pitching with your team and sales training, in about 14 days.

Phase 3 • Asia Expansion
A long-term partnership with investors and regional partners.

Get your free Taiwan Opportunity One-Pager

Tell us about your product. We will send you your top 3 market opportunities in Taiwan and the advantage to sell on.

rollgrp.com

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